

Lesson Nine

Communication, team and conflict management

Management Communication

A Case-Analysis Approach

5th Edition by James Rourke

Ch11: Managing Conflict

Software Project Management

5th Edition by Bob Hughes and Mike Cotterell

Ch12: Working in teams

Presented by

Bowen DU

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Outline

- Definition of conflict.
- Conflict in organizations.
- Source of conflict in organizations.
- Sensing conflict.
- Benefits of dealing with conflict.
- Styles of conflict management.
- Decision making of styles of software team.
- Communication Genres and plans

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Definition

- Conflict is any time we disagree to the point where we can't go forward. (Erik van Slyke)
- Most experts agree that while opposition, incompatibility and interaction are important ingredients in conflict.
- Small matters can quickly mutate from a business conflict to a personality issue. And from there, everything from productivity to working relationships to share price can suffer.

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Conflict in organizations

- Three Views

- **Traditional view:** This perspective assumed that all conflict was bad. Naturally good managers would do all in their power to avoid conflict. A workplace without conflict was assumed to be happy, productive workplace.

- **Human relations view:** This viewpoint assumed that conflict was a natural occurrence in all groups and organizations. Experts rationalized its existence, it can't be eliminated, it may even be beneficial.

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Conflict in organizations

- Three Views
 - **Interactionist view:** The interactionist approach actually encourages conflict on the grounds that a harmonious, peaceful, and cooperative group may become static and unresponsive to a need for change and innovation. Without a minimum level of conflict, no organization can change, adapt, and survive the rigors of the marketplace.

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Source of conflict in organizations

- Five factors seem to appear regularly in the social literature.
 - Limited resources
 - Values, goals and priorities
 - Poorly defined responsibilities
 - Change
 - Human drives for success

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Sensing conflict

- Here are some ways to sense day-to-day conflict in the workplace.
 - Visualize: If I were to change the commitment, how would my crew react?
 - Give feedback: The amount, accuracy and timeliness of information that you can provide to your classmates will help you to understand their viewpoints.
 - Get feedback: Take the time to find out what your associates are thinking and feeling. Don't wait until the last moment to discover that you have trouble.

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Sensing conflict

- Here are some ways to sense day-to-day conflict in the workplace.
 - Define expectations: Meet regularly with your associates to determine priorities for the day ahead or the coming week. Any major misunderstanding between your expectations and theirs will alert you to potential conflict.
 - Review performance regularly: When supervisors and employees communicate openly about how they are (or are not) working together, they reduce the opportunity for serious conflict and help to build stronger working relationship.

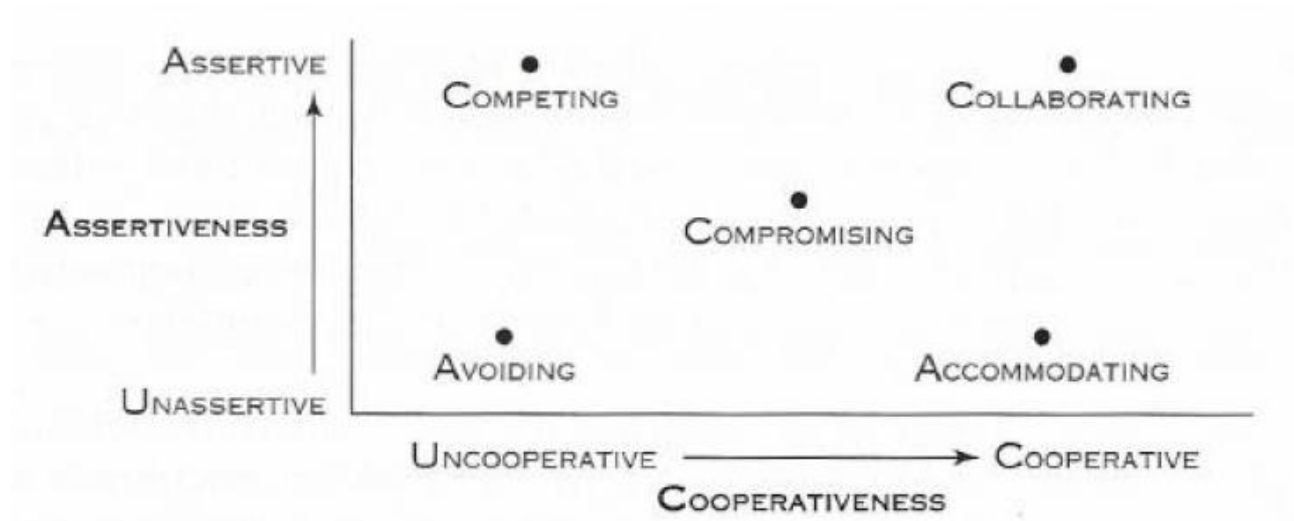
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Benefits of dealing with conflict

- Benefits for you
 - Stronger relationships.
 - Increased self-respect.
 - Personal growth and development.
- Benefits for organization
 - Improved efficiency and effectiveness.
 - Creative thinking.
 - Synergy and teamwork.

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Styles of conflict management



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Styles of conflict management

- Competing
- Collaborating
- Avoiding
- Accommodating
- Compromising

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What should you Do?

- To succeed, you may have to demonstrate skill at each of the five styles of conflict management we have just discussed.
 - Listen, listen and then listen some more.
 - Separate the people from the problem.
 - Focus on interest, not positions.
 - Recognize and accept the feelings of the individuals involved.
 - Keep your own emotions in neutral.
 - Track the conflict to its source.
 - Communicate continually and frankly.
 - Get people together on the small stuff first.
 - Devise options for mutual gain.
 - Define succeed in terms of gains rather than losses.
 - Know when to cut your losses.

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Becoming a team

- Team development has 5 basic stages.
 - **Forming**: know each other, set up ground rules.
 - **Storming**: exert leadership, establish operation methods.
 - **Norming**: settle conflicts, emerge group identity.
 - **Performing**: emphasize the tasks at hand.
 - **Adjourning**: group disbands.

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Becoming a team

- Balance of different types of people in a team.
 - The chair
 - The plant(产生新想法的人)
 - The monitor-evaluator
 - The shaper(塑造者)
 - The team worker
 - The resource investigator
 - The completer-finisher
 - The company worker
- Selecting the essential technical specialists first, and any remaining team members can then be allocated with an eye on making the group roles more balanced.

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Becoming a team - Group performance

- Are groups more effective than individuals working alone?
 - In many projects, judgements are needed about which tasks are best carried out collectively and which are best delegated to individuals.
 - One way of categorizing group tasks is into
 - additive tasks(可加性任务)
 - compensatory tasks(补偿性任务)
 - disjunctive tasks(分离性任务)
 - conjunctive tasks(关联性任务) – group heedfulness(关注)
 - Social loafing(游手好闲)
 - Note: Social loafing is a problem that students often encounter when carrying out group assignments. What steps can participants in a group take to encourage team members to ‘pull their weight’ properly?

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Decision making

- Group decision making
 - Normal complementary decision-making
 - Brainstorming
 - Prototype method
 - JAD(Joint Application Development)
- Obstacles to good group decision making
 - Time-consuming
 - It can stir up conflicts within the group
 - Decisions can be unduly influenced by dominant personalities
 - Risky shift

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Decision making of styles of software team

- Team heedfulness
 - The appearance of a ‘collective mind’ comes from shared understanding, familiarity and good communications.
- Egoless programming
 - Peer code reviews are based on this idea where items produced by individual team members are checked by selected colleagues the experts record their recommendations
- Chief programmer teams
 - Reducing this number but making the remaining programmers as productive as possible by giving them more support.
- Extreme programming(XP)
- Scrum

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Communication Genres

- Time/place constraints on some communication methods

	Same place	Different place
Same time	Meetings	Telephone
	Interviews etc.	Instant messaging
Different times	Noticeboards	E-mail
	Pigeon-holes	Voicemail
		Documents

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- What would be the best mode of communication for the following?
 - A developer needs clarification of what is meant by a particular term used in a specification.
 - A finance director needs to ensure that a software application is changed to conform with new legal requirements.

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Communication Plans

- **Princeton Project Methodology**
 - **What:** This contains the name of a particular communication event, for example 'kick-off meeting', or a communication channel.
 - **Who/target:** The target audience for the communication.
 - **Purpose:** What the communication is to achieve.
 - **When/frequency:** If the communication by means of a single event, then a specific date can be supplied. If the event is a recurring one, such as a progress meeting, then the frequency should be indicated.
 - **Type/method:** The nature of the communication, for example a meeting or a distributed document.
 - **Responsibility:** The person who initiates the communication.

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Assignment of Lesson **Nine**

- Hold the **first milestone meeting** between **27 April** and **10 May** to exam the progress and outcome of the course project. The specific requirement will be released in Canvas.
- Submit the **second biweekly report** at **26 April**
- Continually submit the **design document**, the **test document**, the **user manual** and the **source code** to Canva and Github until **14 June**.